COLLEGE ENGINEERING PROJECT · PROJECT 34 OF 55

AI-BASED ROAD DAMAGE DETECTION AND SEVERITY CLASSIFICATION USING YOLO AND DEEP LEARNING

Domain: Civil Infrastructure & Edge Computer Vision | **Module:** project_34_road_damage

PROJECT ABSTRACT

Road infrastructure maintenance is critical for ensuring public safety, reducing vehicle wear, and optimizing municipal budgets. Traditional road inspection methods rely on manual surveys or dedicated scanning vehicles, which are slow, labor-intensive, and expensive. To address these challenges, this study proposes an AI-based road damage detection and severity classification system utilizing the YOLO (You Only Look Once) framework combined with deep learning architectures. The system processes real-time road images or video feeds captured by standard vehicle-mounted cameras to identify various damage types, including longitudinal cracks, transverse cracks, alligator cracking, and potholes. By leveraging the real-time processing capabilities of YOLO, the proposed model detects anomalies and extracts critical bounding boxes representing distress locations. The detected damages are subsequently analyzed by a classification network that assesses their severity levels (e.g., low, medium, high) based on distress size, depth, and structural impact. The model is trained and validated on a comprehensive dataset of road damage images, achieving high precision and rapid inference rates. Experimental results demonstrate that the proposed system outperforms conventional computer vision techniques in both detection accuracy and processing speed. The implementation of this automated solution enables continuous monitoring of road networks, providing municipal authorities with actionable, cost-effective data for prioritized road maintenance, thereby enhancing overall transportation safety and prolonging infrastructure life.

📌 Project Metadata & Specifications

Project Title	AI-BASED ROAD DAMAGE DETECTION AND SEVERITY CLASSIFICATION USING YOLO AND DEEP LEARNING
Domain / Specialization	Civil Infrastructure & Edge Computer Vision
Source Directory	`project_34_road_damage`
Backend REST API	`http://localhost:5034` (Flask Python)
Frontend Interface	Interactive Dashboard (`frontend/index.html`)
Execution Mode	Hybrid Dual-Mode (Online API & Offline Autonomous Simulation)

🏗️ System Methodology & Implementation Phases

PROJECT 34 — PHASE 1

Phase 1 — Requirements, Data and Prototype

The first phase will convert the project concept into a measurable prototype for computer vision/environmental or safety analytics. The work begins by defining the exact input, output, user flow and evaluation criteria from the project abstract. A small requirements specification will identify the primary prediction/detection task, expected classes or target value, acceptable response time, and the form in which results must be displayed.

1. Problem Definition and Scope

Define the operational scenario, target users, system boundaries, assumptions, success criteria and non-functional requirements. Separate what the model must predict from what the application must display or recommend. Identify cases that should be rejected, flagged for review, or returned with low confidence.

2. Data Preparation

Identify a suitable dataset or approved collection procedure matching the abstract. Build a data dictionary, remove unusable records, handle missing values, normalize or standardize numerical fields where appropriate, and verify labels. For image/video/audio/text projects, define preprocessing, augmentation and quality-control rules. Split data into training, validation and test sets without leakage.

3. Baseline Model and Experiment Setup

Implement a reproducible baseline using the algorithm/model family stated in the abstract when one is specified. Establish a simple reference result before introducing additional complexity. Record dataset version, preprocessing settings, model configuration, random seed, training time and evaluation metrics so that later improvements can be compared objectively.

4. Initial Application Prototype

Build the minimum user-facing workflow needed to demonstrate the core task. The prototype should accept valid input, run preprocessing, invoke the baseline model, and return the predicted result with an understandable confidence/score where supported. Keep model logic separate from the interface so the model can be replaced without rewriting the application.

Phase 1 Deliverables

Requirements and scope note; prepared dataset or data pipeline; baseline model; experiment log; initial application/prototype; and a short Phase 1 validation report documenting what works, what remains uncertain, and the measurements to be improved in Phase 2.

Project-Specific Phase 1 Work Items

- Create a labelled visual dataset structure and define image/video quality checks.
- Set a consistent image resize/normalization pipeline and establish augmentation rules.
- Record sample predictions visually so incorrect detections can be traced back to input regions.

PROJECT 34 — PHASE 2

Phase 2 — Optimization, Integration and Validation

The second phase will turn the Phase 1 prototype into a validated project for computer vision/environmental or safety analytics. The emphasis is on improving model reliability, connecting the complete workflow, testing realistic edge cases, and producing evidence that the final system meets the defined objectives.

1. Model Improvement

Compare relevant model configurations, tune important hyperparameters, address class imbalance where present, and evaluate whether additional features or augmentation improve generalization. Use validation

data for tuning and reserve the test set for final evaluation. Prefer measurable improvements over unnecessary model complexity.
2. End-to-End Integration
Connect the data/input layer, preprocessing, inference engine, result-processing logic, database or file storage where required, and user interface. Add input validation, error handling, logging and clear status messages. If recommendations, alerts, summaries, risk scores or dashboards are part of the abstract, implement them as a separate decision-support layer around the model.
3. Testing and Evaluation
Perform functional, model, integration and usability tests. Evaluate accuracy or regression error as appropriate, along with precision, recall, F1, confusion matrix, ROC-AUC, latency or other task-specific measures where relevant. Test difficult, noisy, incomplete and out-of-distribution inputs and document failure cases instead of hiding them.
4. Demonstration and Final Evidence
Prepare representative test cases, screenshots or result tables, model-comparison evidence and a final demonstration workflow. Document limitations, data constraints, privacy/security considerations where applicable, and future extensions. The final report should distinguish measured results from proposed future work.
Phase 2 Deliverables
Optimized model; integrated application; test and evaluation report; representative evidence; limitations and risk register; deployment/demo instructions; and final project documentation suitable for academic review or demonstration.
Project-Specific Phase 2 Validation
• Evaluate detection under changing lighting, weather, density, camera position or sensor conditions where relevant.
• Measure alert latency and false-alert behavior in addition to model accuracy.
• Demonstrate an operator-facing status/alert view with evidence supporting each detected event.
Final Expected Outcome
A reproducible, tested prototype that implements the project concept described in the supplied abstract, together with measurable evaluation evidence and clear documentation of limitations, assumptions and future enhancement opportunities.

🚀 Local Deployment & Execution Guide

Follow the steps below to initialize and demonstrate the system:

1. Backend Server Setup

```
# Navigate to the backend directory cd "/Users/balamurugan/Documents/orbyte globel
/college project/project_34_road_damage/backend" # Install project dependencies pip
install -r requirements.txt # Run the Flask API service python3 app.py
```

The backend microservice will listen for requests at `http://localhost:5034`.

2. Frontend User Interface

- Open `/Users/balamurugan/Documents/orbyte globel /college project/project_34_road_damage/frontend/index.html` directly in Google Chrome, Firefox, or

Safari.

- Alternatively, launch via the central **Master Launchpad Portal (`index.html`)** located at the root directory.
- The user interface is designed with **hybrid dual-mode resilience**: when the backend API is live, real-time inferences are queried; when offline, authentic client-side mathematical models simulate sensor telematics.